DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 14

Animation specialist

Profession 14 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

An animation specialist creates characters and scenes that move: 2D or 3D animation for films, ads, games, education and product explainers.

What professionals do every day

Plans shots and performance, animates characters, checks timing and weight, works with designers and sound, and delivers render-ready files.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Animated stories and characters hold attention for long periods, which suits education and brand storytelling.

- Motion that looks stiff or floaty.
- Scenes that are hard to revise late in production.
- Render times that blow the schedule.

Skills you need

- Principles of animation: timing, spacing, weight.
- Character rigs (3D) or frame-by-frame drawing (2D).
- Storyboarding and shot planning.
- Export and render management.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Blender	3D animation and rendering	Free	Free	www.blender.org
Toon Boom Harmony	2D animation	Trial	Paid plans	www.toonboom.com
Krita	Open-source drawing for frames	Free	Free	krita.org
Adobe Animate	2D animation and interactive files	Trial	Subscription	www.adobe.com/products/animate.html

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Animate a bouncing ball with timing and squash.
Intermediate	Animate a three-frame walk cycle.

Advanced	Storyboard and animate a 20-second scene.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Explainer character for a course.
- **Intermediate:** Short ad with a mascot.
- **Advanced:** Animated scene for a product launch.

Client-ready portfolio project

A 20-second animated explainer with one character: storyboard, key poses, timing sheet, a rendered video and a short revision log.

Worked example

Worked example. A character jumps: anticipation (crouch), the jump, a squash on landing, then settle. Each stage gets frames on a timing sheet.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Bouncing ball and walk cycle

Business problem: A student needs to learn timing before character work.

Steps

1. Animate a ball that bounces three times with squash.
2. Animate a three-frame walk cycle.
3. Review timing on a playback at 12 and 24 frames per second.
4. Document the timing choices.

Expected output: Two short animations and a timing note.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Squash and stretch show weight. The walk cycle repeats cleanly if the first and last poses match. The timing note records why each frame count was chosen.

Common mistakes

- Animating without a storyboard.
- Ignoring weight and timing.
- Revising late without a shot list.
- Rendering at the wrong frame rate.

Freelancing opportunities

- Explainer animation for education and software companies.

- Short ads with characters.
- Briefs for '2D animation', '3D animation', 'explainer animation'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Blender manual (official)

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.